Hands-On Projects 1-4

Exploring the Fedora Linux Interface

Time Required: 15 minutes

Objective: Explore the Fedora Linux desktop.

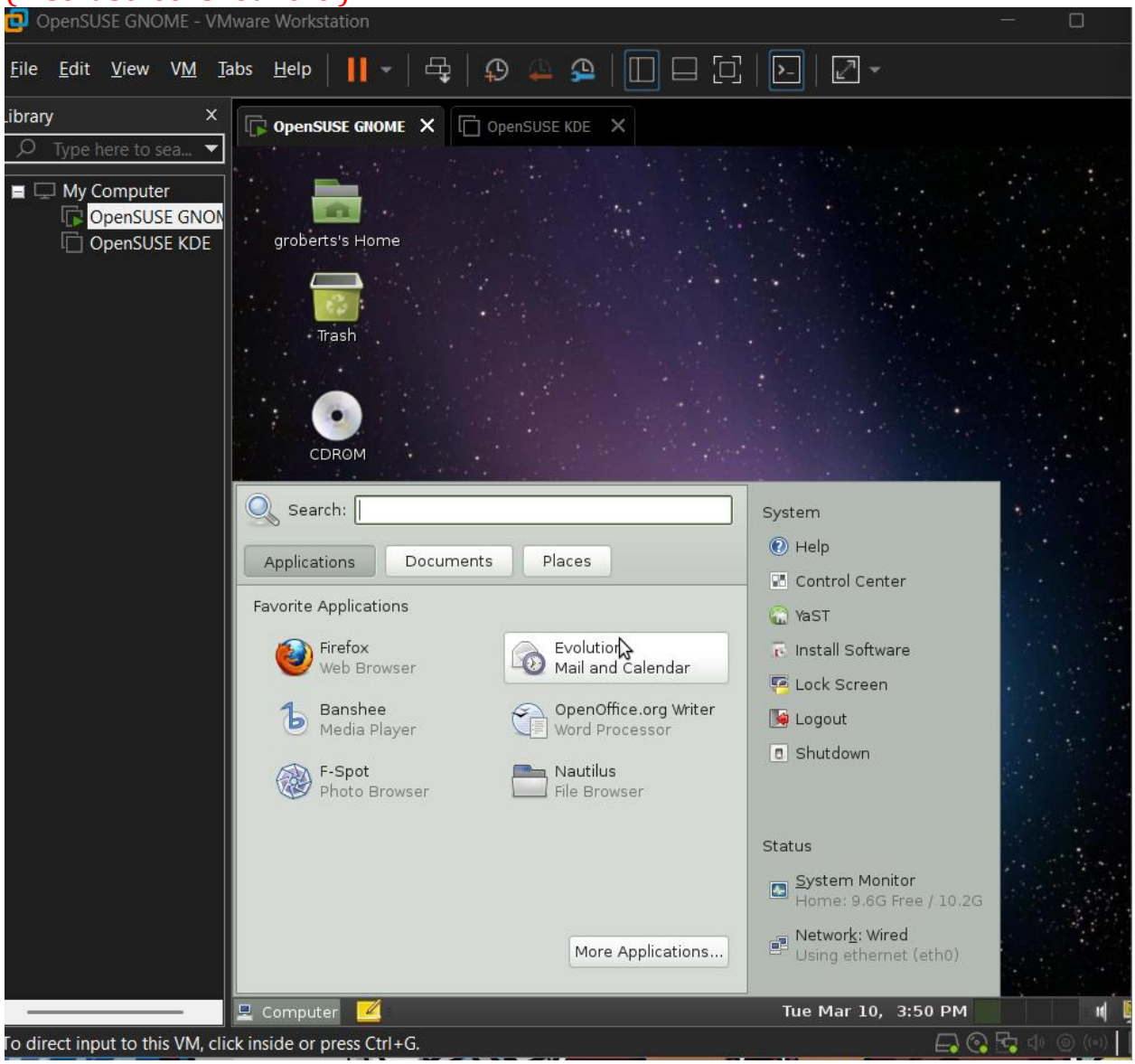
Required Tools and Equipment: A Fedora 30 Linux virtual machine or computer, as specified in the "Before You Begin" section of the Preface

Description: In this project, you explore the Fedora 30 desktop and view some of the common tools available in Fedora 30. While you can use other versions of Linux, Fedora 30 is suggested for these projects because they are written with that distribution in mind. Note that Fedora 30 comes with the GNOME desktop by default.

1. Start your VM hosted Linux computer on your Windows 10 Host and log on.

2. Notice the bar at the top of the desktop. This is the top panel, which contains the Activities menu, a digital clock, and a place to access settings for the network, control the sound volume, and log on and off from the system. Click **Activities** to access the Favorites side panel and the search box.

(Insert Screenshot here.)



3. 3

In the Favorites side panel (see Figure 1-15), you have access to common applications such as a Web browser and a file manager. Applications can be added to this panel; you'll do this in the next module. Click the **Show Applications** icon (it looks like a square grid of white dots) at the bottom of the panel to see more tasks and apps.

(Insert Screenshot here.)

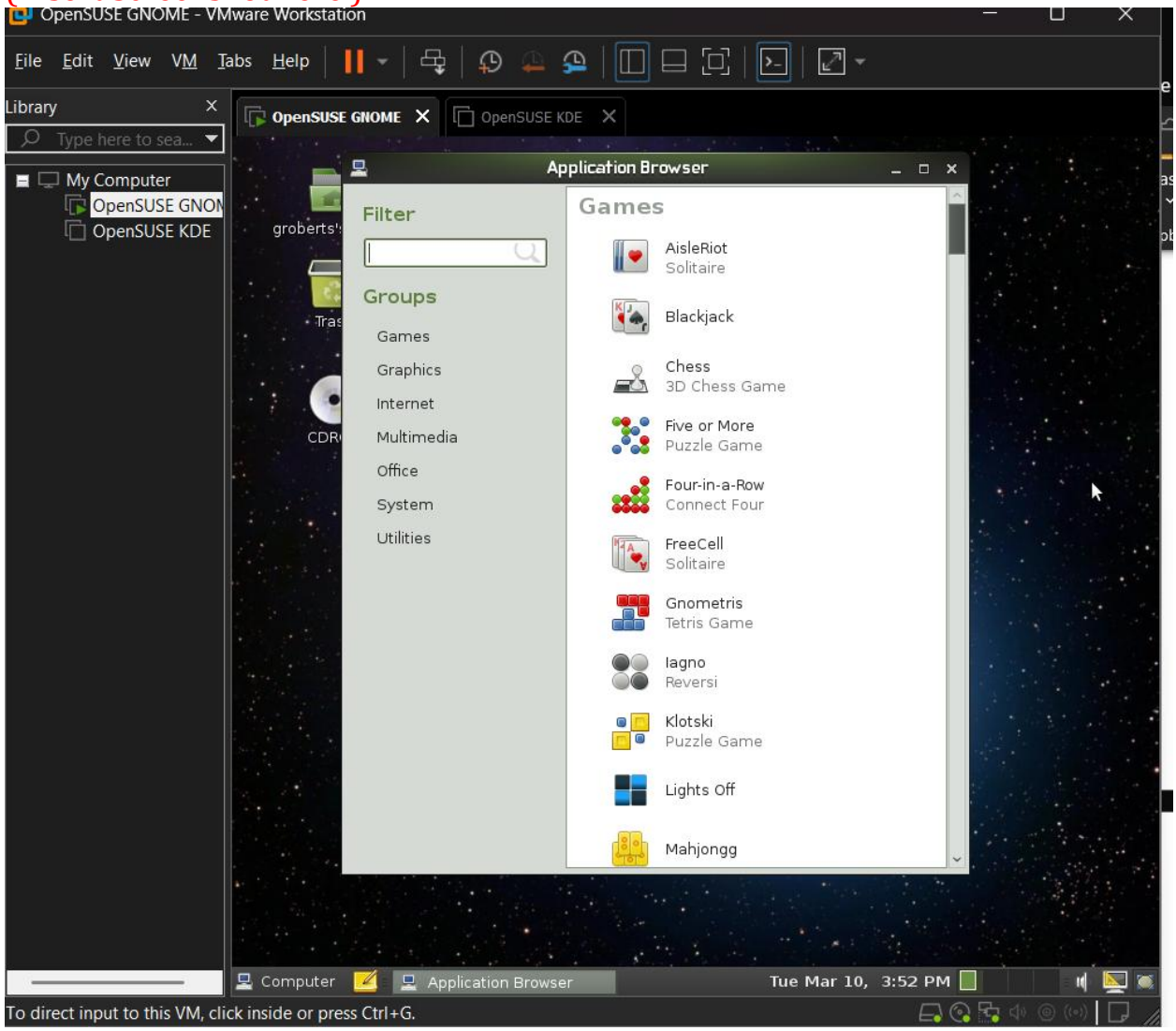
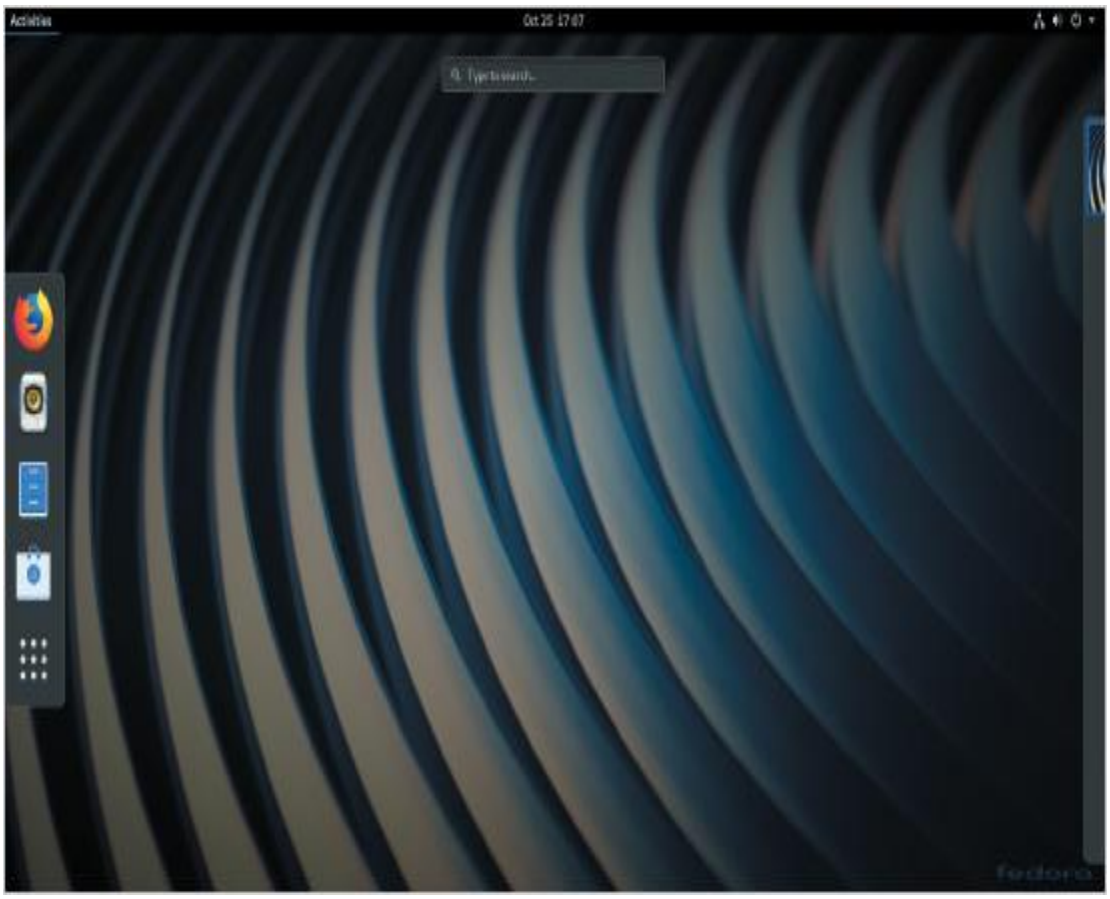


Figure 1-15

Fedora 30 with the GNOME desktop, Favorites side panel, and search box



4.

Click **Settings** to see a list of settings tools. Click **Details** near the bottom of the Settings window to see basic system information (see Figure 1-16). Click each of the options in the left pane to see what can be configured from here. Close the Details window.

(Insert Screenshot here.)

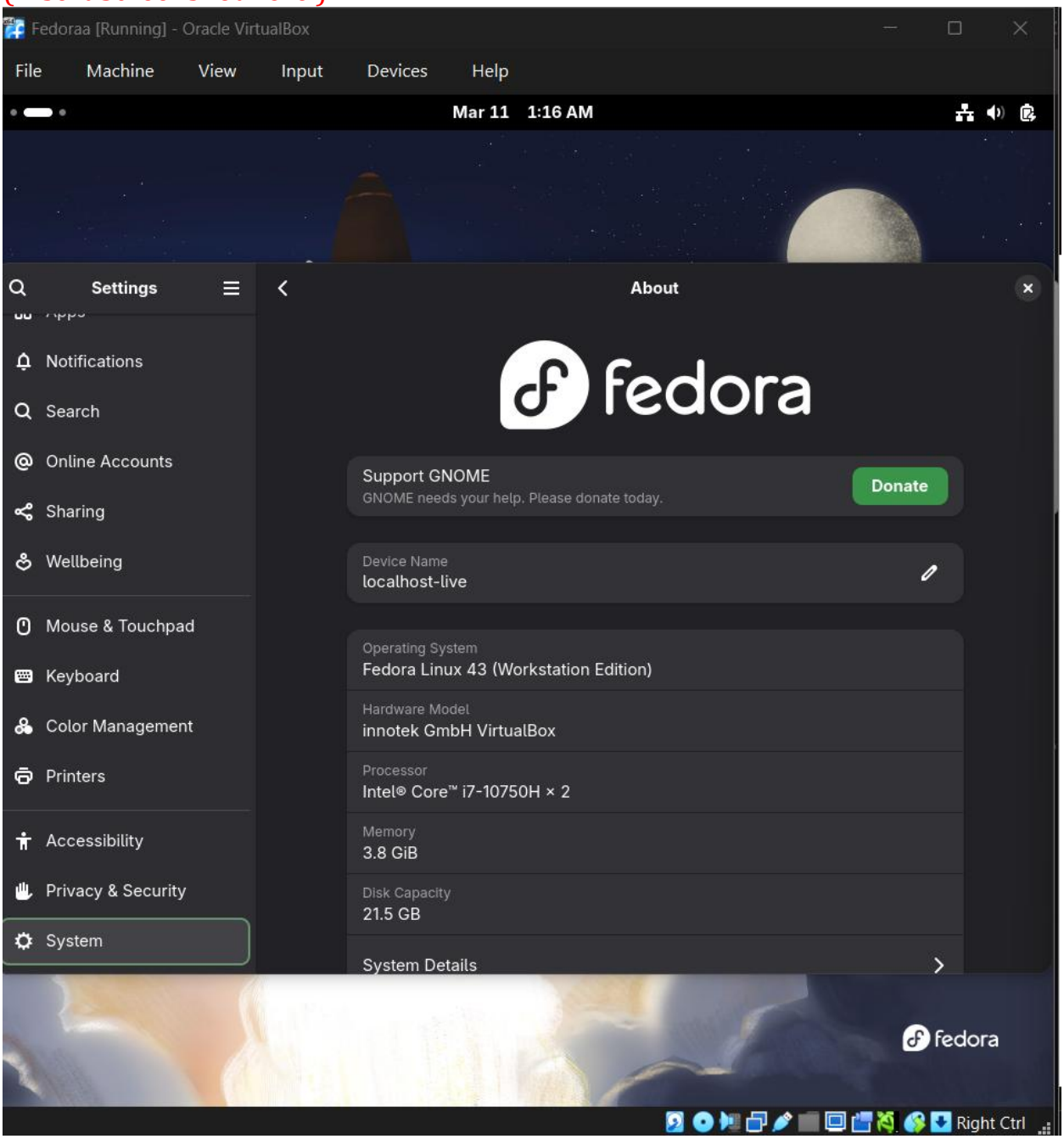
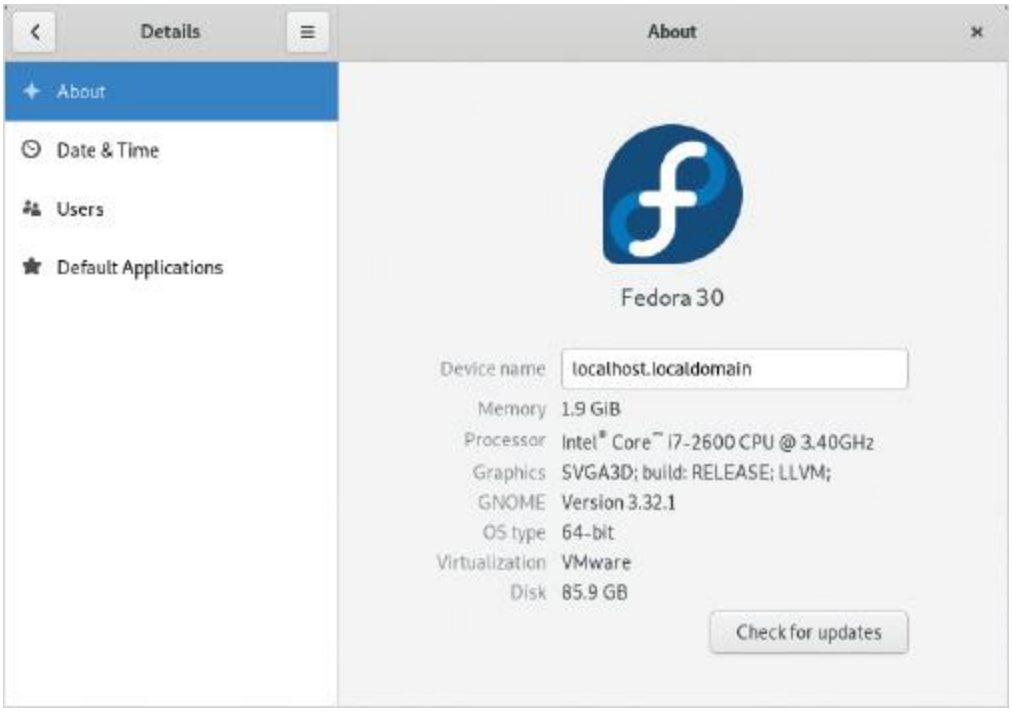


Figure 1-16

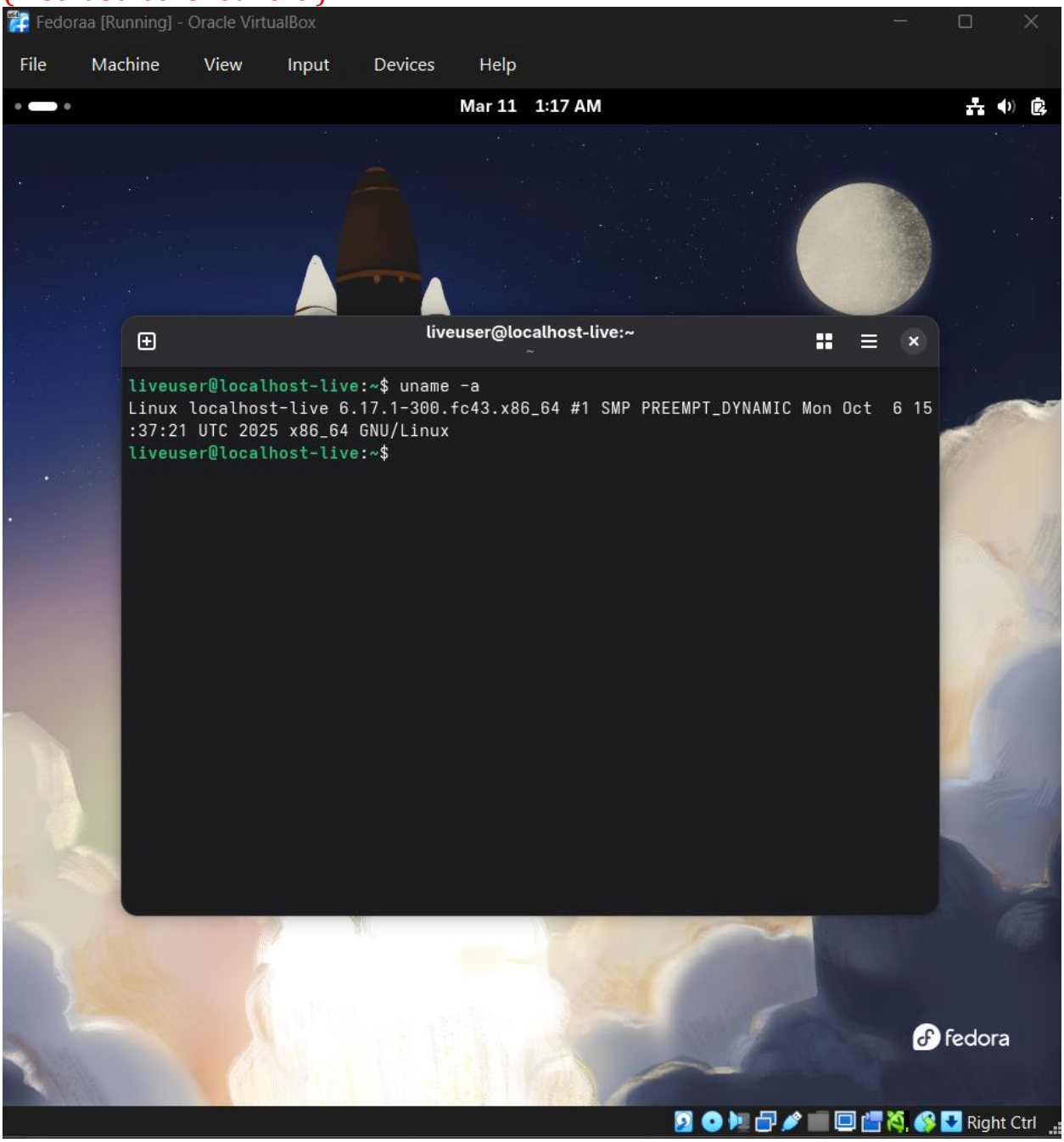
The Details window in Linux



5. Click **Activities** and click the **Show Applications** icon. Click **Utilities** to see a list of utilities that come with Fedora, including a calculator, disk management utilities, and system monitoring.
(Insert Screenshot here.)

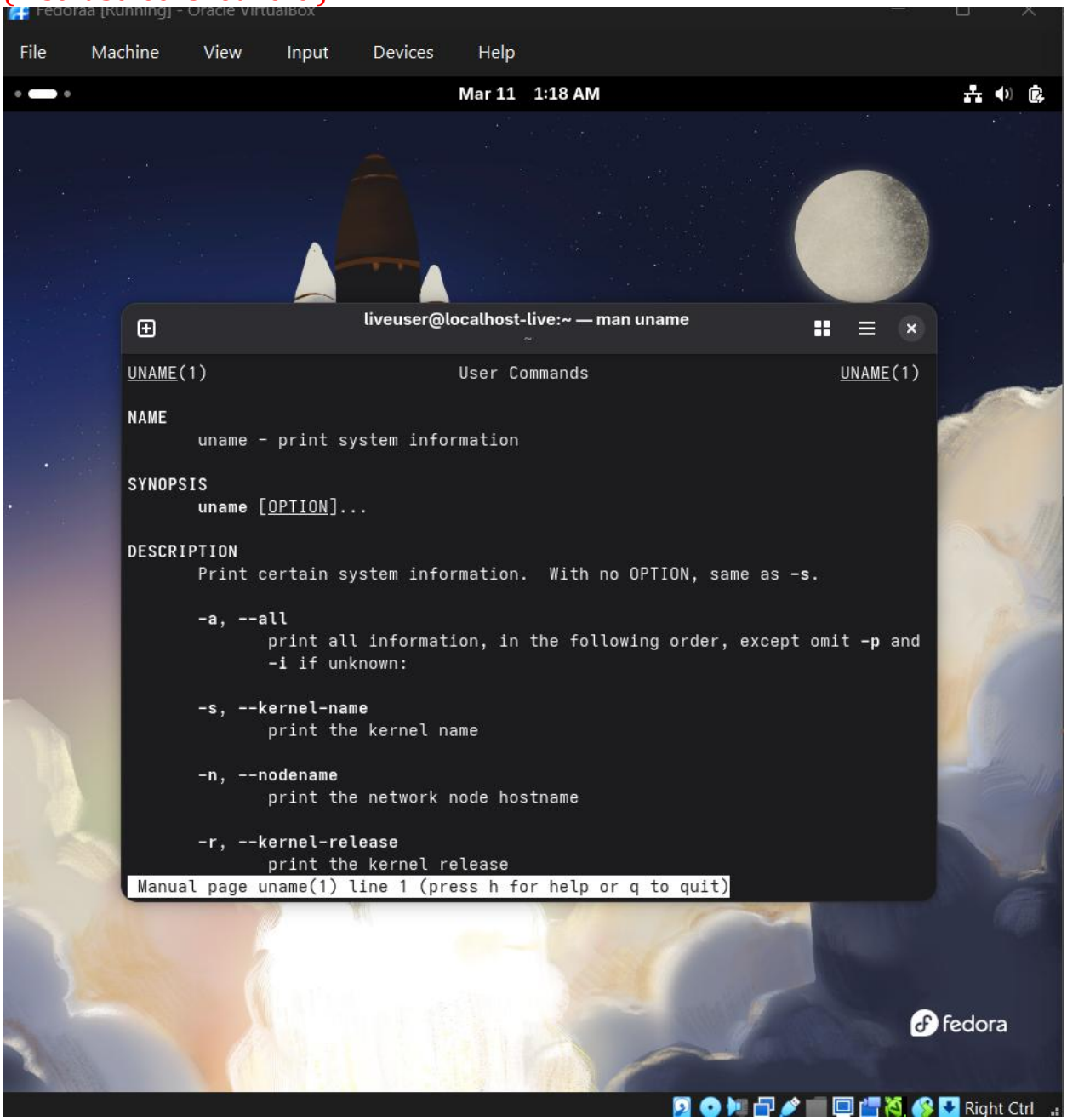
6. Click **Terminal** to open the terminal application, which provides a command-line interface to Linux, much like the command prompt in Windows. In the terminal window, type **uname –a** to see detailed version information for the Linux OS and the kernel.

(Insert Screenshot here.)



7. Type **man uname** and press **Enter**. The resulting display provides documentation about the *uname* command. (The *man* command is used to access the Linux help system.)

(Insert Screenshot here.)



8.

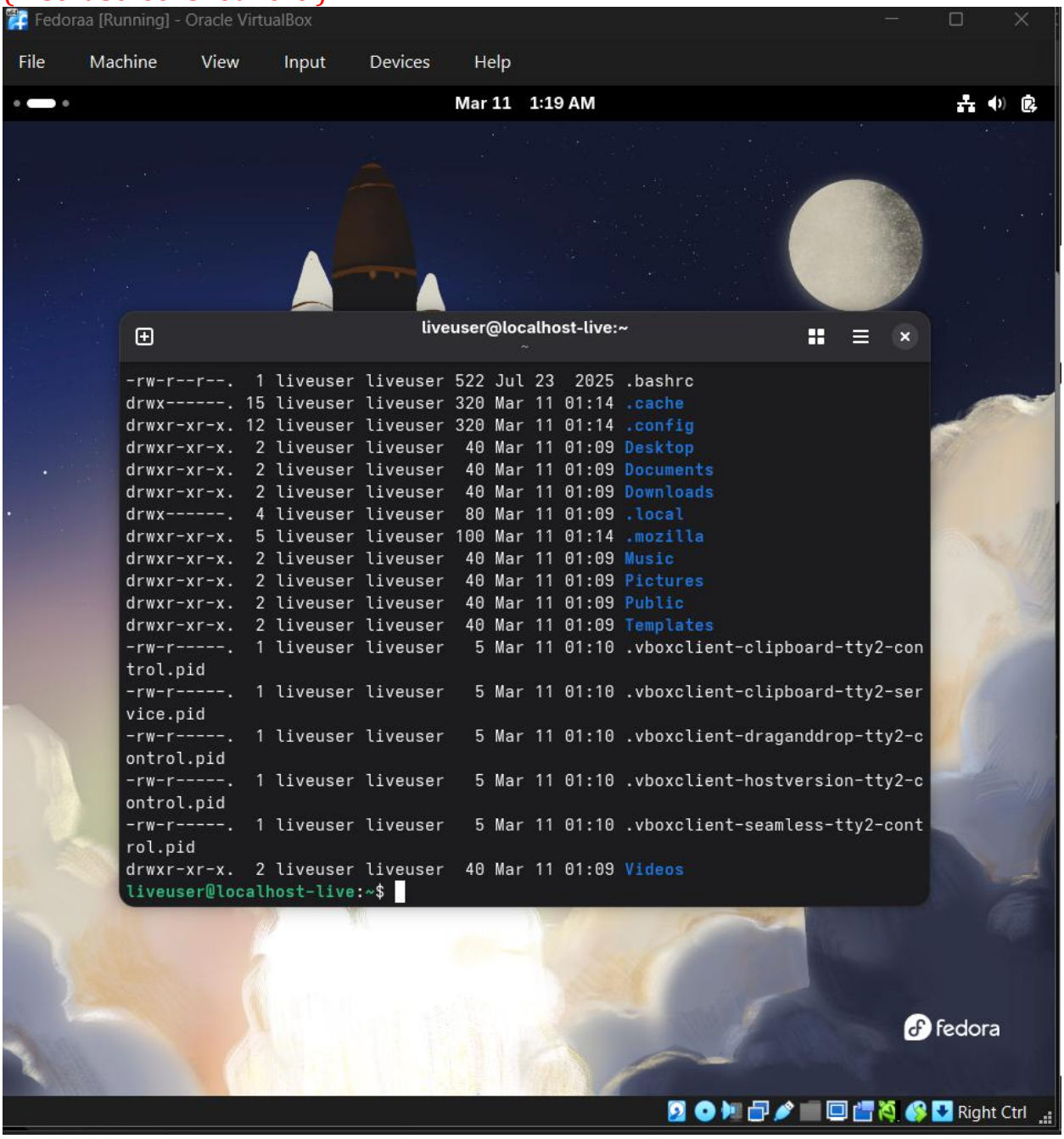
Press **Page Up** and **Page Down** to page through the manual pages. When you are finished browsing the man pages, press **q** to exit the manual documentation.

9.

Type **ls -la** and press **Enter** to view information about files in the current folder. The current folder is shown by the information in the brackets

before the $ prompt. The default prompt syntax is *user@computer folder*, where *user* is the logged-on user, *computer* is the name of the computer (localhost is the name by default), and *folder* is the name of the folder the shell is currently in, which is called the working directory in Linux. Your working directory likely is shown as ~, which is shorthand for the user's home folder.

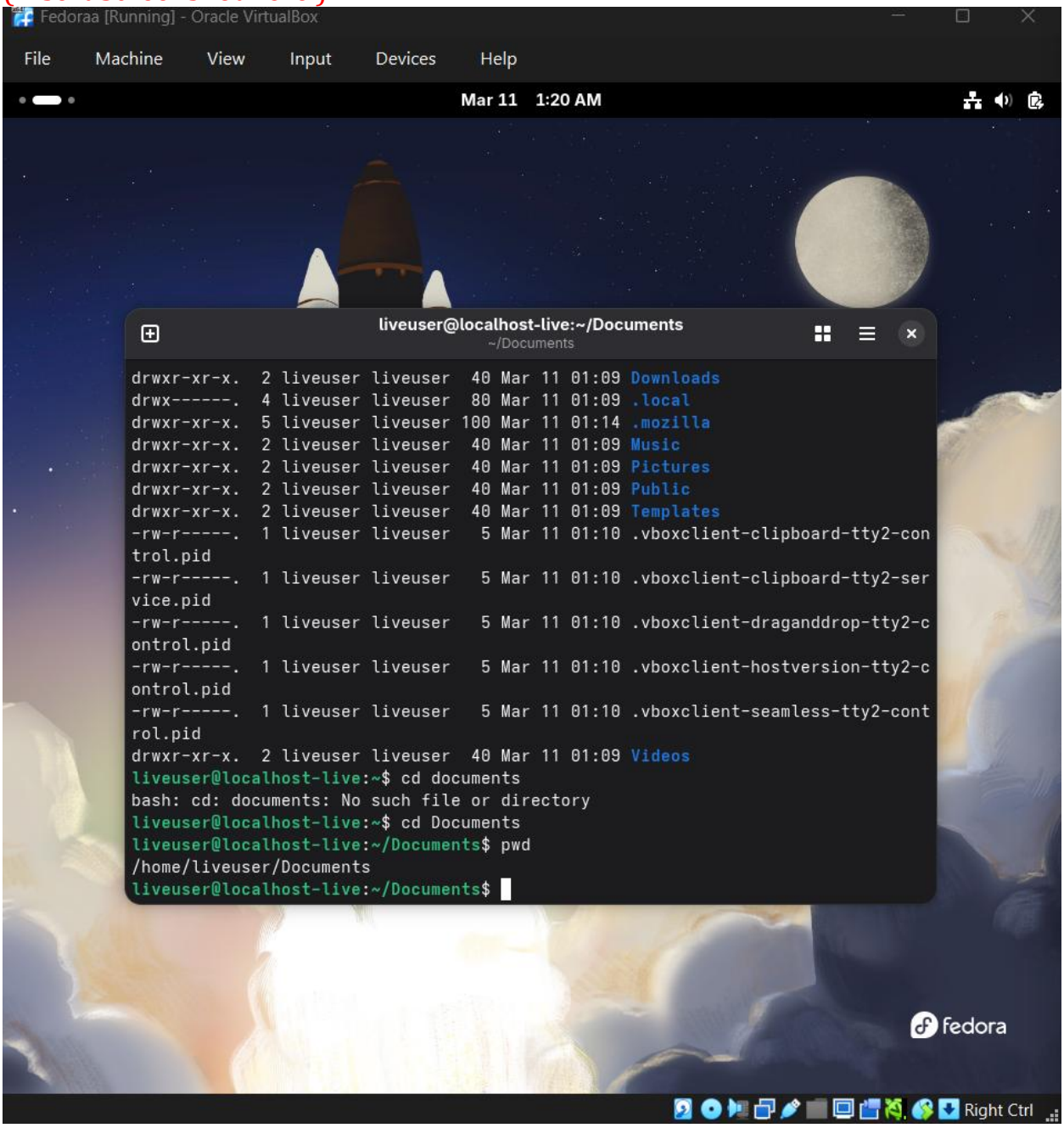
(Insert Screenshot here.)



10.

Type **cd Documents** and press **Enter**. Case is important in Linux, so *Documents* is different from *documents*; be sure to capitalize the *D*. You see that your prompt changes, but unlike the Windows command prompt, you don't see the entire path. To see the entire path of your working directory, type **pwd** and press **Enter** (*pwd* stands for "print working directory").

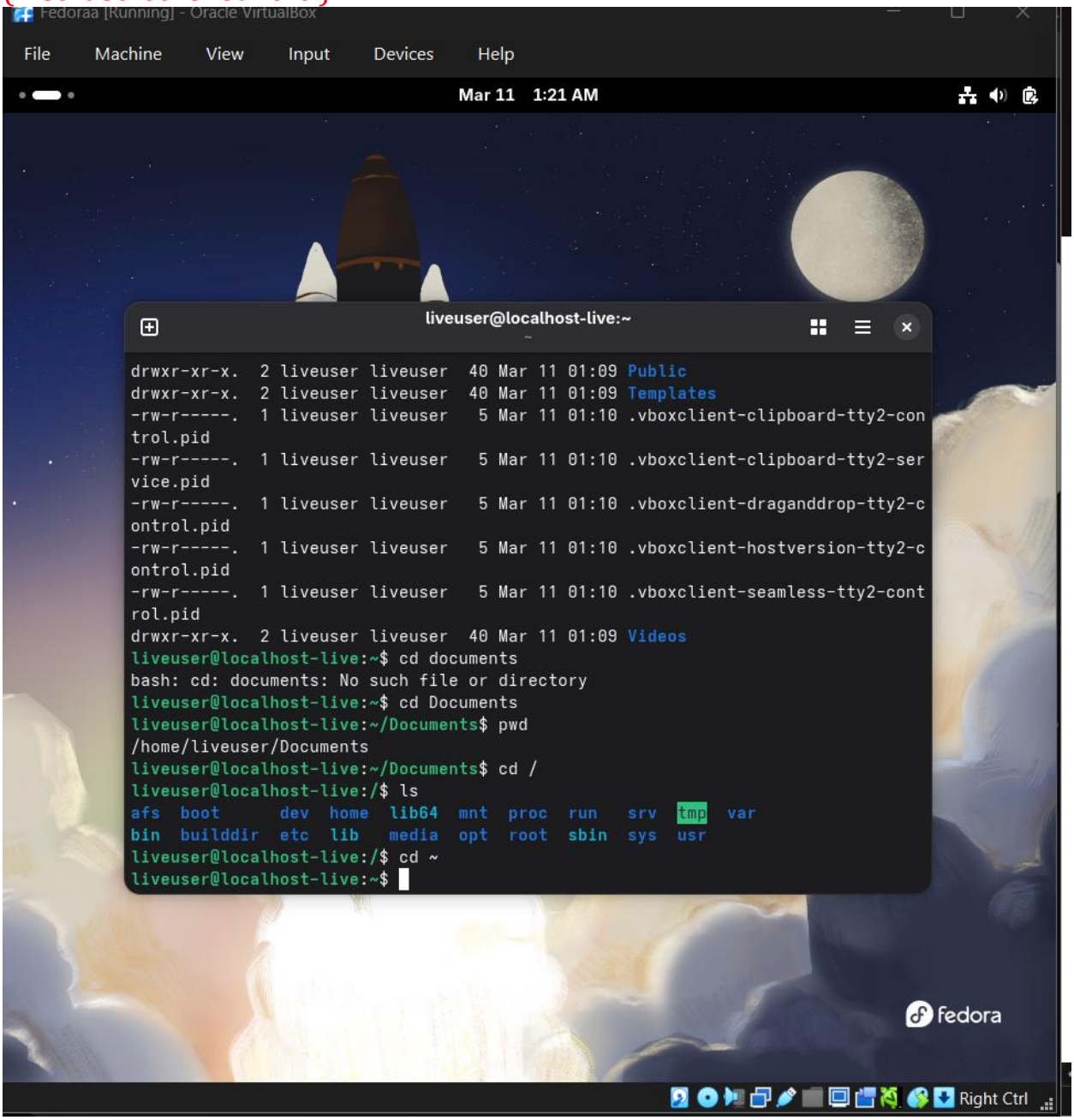
(Insert Screenshot here.)



11.

Type **cd /** (be sure to use a forward slash) and press **Enter** to go to the root of the file system. Type **ls** and press **Enter** to see a list of folders in the root. Type **cd ~** and press **Enter** to get back to your home folder. Close the terminal window.

(Insert Screenshot here.)

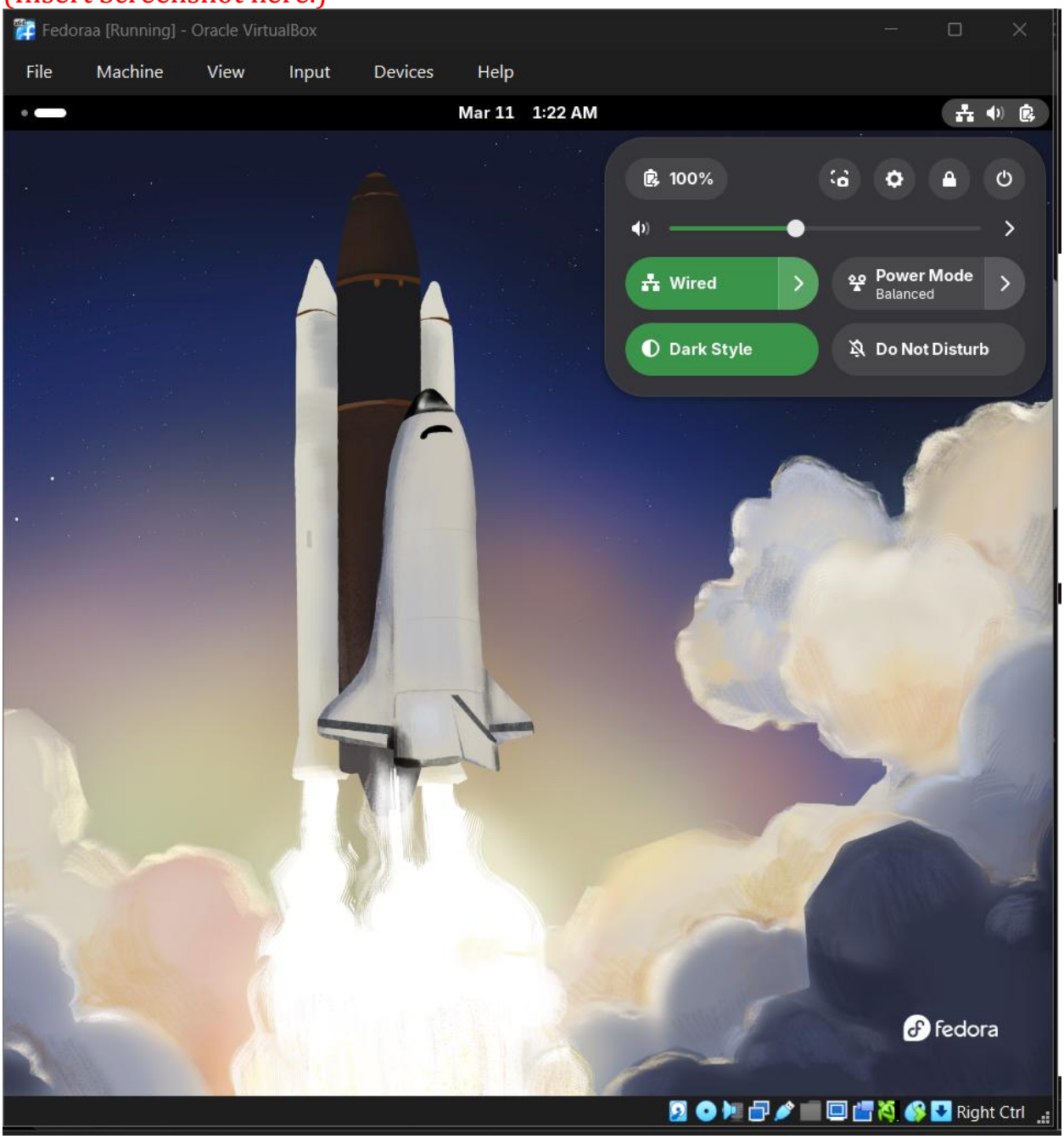


12.

On the far right side of the desktop, click the power icon. A small panel opens. Here you can adjust the sound volume, manage network connections, view information about the current user, log off the system,

and shut down or lock the system, among other things. On the lower-right side of the open panel, click the power icon. You are informed that the system will power off in 60 seconds.

(Insert Screenshot here.)



Click **Cancel** if you are continuing to the next project.